



Massachusetts
SNAP Benefits Application for Seniors
(For individuals and couples age 60 or older)



How do I apply for SNAP benefits?

- Upload to [DTAConnect](#)
- Fax to **617-887-8765**
- Mail to **DTA Document Processing Center, P.O. Box 4406, Taunton, MA 02780-0420**
- Scan at a local **DTA** office

Last Name:			First Name:			Middle Name:					
Home Address:						City, State, Zip Code:					
Mailing Address (if different):						City, State, Zip Code:					
Phone Number:						Are you homeless? ☐ Yes ☐ No					
What type of housing do you live in?											
☐ Private Housing				☐ Residential Facility				☐ Shelter			
☐ Transitional Housing				☐ Migrant Campsite				☐ Temporary Housing			
☐ Public Housing				☐ Commercial Boarding House				☐ Other			
By signing, I agree that:											
• I have read this entire form (or have had it read to me in a language that I understand), including the section about rights and responsibilities, and understand that I must comply with these rules; • the information I am giving is true and complete to the best of my knowledge; • I could go to prison or be required to pay fines if I knowingly give wrong or incomplete information; • DTA and other federal, state, and local officials may verify (check) any information I give.											
Signature:						Date:					

- We will accept your application if it has your name, address (if any), and signature.
- If approved, your SNAP benefits will be issued back to the date DTA got your application.
- Call us to complete an interview anytime between 8:15 AM and 4:45 PM, Monday through Friday, at 1-833-712-8027.

You may get SNAP benefits within 7 days if:

- Your gross income and money in the bank add up to less than your monthly housing expenses; or
- Your monthly gross income is less than \$150, and your money in the bank is \$100 or less; or
- You are a migrant worker and your money in the bank is \$100 or less.

Do you have a Massachusetts Electronic Benefit Transfer (EBT) card?

☐ Yes ☐ No

EBT cards still work if a case reopens after being closed. If you do not have an EBT card, we can mail you one or print one at a local office. You may get an EBT card before we decide eligibility so you can use your benefits as soon as they are available, if you are eligible. When you get your EBT card, you will also get more information on how to use it.



If you need help because of a disability, we can give an accommodation to make it easier to work with us.

Call 1-877-382-2363 to request an accommodation or help with the application.



Are you a person with a disability?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, what is your preferred method of communication?

☐ In-Person

☐ American Sign Language - In-Person

☐ Telephone

☐ American Sign Language - Video Relay Services (VRS)

Your VRS Phone #:

Has MassHealth certified that you have a disability?

☐ Yes

☐ No

DTA may send you text messages about due dates, case information, office closings, and other important information. Please note that message and data charges may apply.

If you **do not** want to receive texts from DTA, you can opt-out on DTA Connect, call us at 1-877-382-2363, or text OPT OUT if you receive a text.

Information about you		
Social Security Number:	Date of Birth:	Gender: ☐ Male ☐ Female
Are you a U.S. Citizen? ☐ Yes ☐ No NOTE: Noncitizens who are not applying for SNAP do not have to give their Social Security Number or citizenship status.		What language do you prefer to speak? _____
What is your race?* ☐ Black or African American ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native ☐ White ☐ Asian ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander What is your ethnicity?* ☐ Hispanic or Latino ☐ Not Hispanic or Latino * Your answer will not affect your eligibility. We ask these questions to make sure that everyone is treated fairly regardless of race, color, or national origin. Leave blank if you prefer not to answer.		

Household Members					
Do other people live with you? ☐ Yes ☐ No If yes , please fill out the section below.					
<u>Name</u>	<u>Date of Birth</u>	<u>Social Security Number</u>	<u>Relation to you?</u>	<u>Is this person a US citizen?</u>	<u>Is this person applying for SNAP benefits?</u>
				☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No
				☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No
				☐ Yes ☐ No	☐ Yes ☐ No

Income				
Does anyone receive income such as Employment, Unemployment Compensation, Child Support, Social Security, SSI, Workers' Compensation, Veterans' Benefits, Pensions or Rental Income? ☐ Yes ☐ No				
If yes , please fill out the section below:				
<u>Person with Income</u>	<u>Income Type</u>	<u>Frequency</u>		<u>Gross Amount</u>
		☐ Weekly ☐ Biweekly	☐ Monthly ☐ Other:	
		☐ Weekly ☐ Biweekly	☐ Monthly ☐ Other:	
		☐ Weekly ☐ Biweekly	☐ Monthly ☐ Other:	

Shelter Costs

Is the household responsible to pay shelter costs?

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

Type:

Amount:

Frequency:

☐ Rent

\$ _____

☐ Monthly

☐ Quarterly

☐ Annually

☐ Other:

☐ Mortgage

\$ _____

☐ Monthly

☐ Quarterly

☐ Annually

☐ Other:

☐ Property Taxes*

\$ _____

☐ Monthly

☐ Quarterly

☐ Annually

☐ Other:

☐ Home Insurance*

\$ _____

☐ Monthly

☐ Quarterly

☐ Annually

☐ Other:

☐ Condo fee

\$ _____

☐ Monthly

☐ Quarterly

☐ Annually

☐ Other:

☐ Other

\$ _____

☐ Monthly

☐ Quarterly

☐ Annually

☐ Other:

* Leave Property Taxes and Home Insurance blank if these are included in the mortgage payment.

Utility Costs

Is the household responsible to pay utility costs **separate** from shelter costs?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, check off all the utility costs that apply to you:

☐ **Heat** (oil, gas, electricity or propane, etc.)

☐ **Electricity and/or gas**

(other than heating use); water; sewage; and/or trash collection

☐ **Electricity for an air conditioner in the summer**

☐ **A fee to use an air conditioner in the summer**

☐ **Phone or cell phone service**
(including pre-paid)

Dependent Care Costs

Is anyone responsible to pay for adult dependent care costs? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

Name of Dependent

Amount Paid

Frequency

_____ \$ _____

☐ Weekly ☐ Biweekly ☐ Monthly

☐ Other:

_____ \$ _____

☐ Weekly ☐ Biweekly ☐ Monthly

☐ Other:

Does anyone travel to and/or from a dependent care provider? ☒ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

<u>Name of Dependent</u>	<u>Address of Care Provider</u>	<u>Number of Car Trips per Week</u>		<u>If Not Driving: Cost of Public Transportation, Taxi Cab, Shuttle, etc.</u>
		TO	FROM	

Medical Costs

Does anyone who is at least 60 years old and/or disabled have **out-of-pocket medical expenses**? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

<u>Name</u>	<u>Expense Type</u>	<u>Total Cost Per Month</u>
_____	☐ Medical Care ☐ Dental Care ☐ Health Insurance ☐ Medications ☐ Other (over-the-counter medications, medical supplies, etc.)	_____
_____	☐ Medical Care ☐ Dental Care ☐ Health Insurance ☐ Medications ☐ Other (over-the-counter medications, medical supplies, etc.)	_____

NOTE: You can get credit for the costs you are responsible for paying even if you are behind or cannot pay them. Medical costs include co-pays, prescriptions, over-the-counter medications, health insurance, medical bills, transportation, and more.

Does anyone travel to and/or from medical care (such as a pharmacy, doctor, therapist, etc.)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

<u>Name</u>	<u>Address of Medical Provider</u>	<u>Number of Car Trips per Week</u>		<u>Cost of Parking, Public Transportation, Taxi Cab, Shuttle, etc.</u>
		TO	FROM	

SNAP in Another State

Has anyone received SNAP benefits outside Massachusetts within the past 30 days? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, who?

Has anyone received a strike in another state for not meeting the SNAP Work Rules? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, who?

Assisting with Application

Do you want to give us permission to contact a person or agency if we cannot reach you by phone? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

Name of Person or Agency: _____

Phone Number: _____

Address: _____

* We call this an Assisting Person/Agency. This role is only valid during the application period.

Authorization to Release Information

Do you want to give a person or agency permission to speak with DTA and get relevant confidential information about your case?*

☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

Name of Person or Agency: _____

Phone Number: _____

Address: _____

* This role cannot report changes or complete interviews. Permission expires after one year.

Authorized Representative for Certification

Do you want to give an agency or someone you trust permission to sign forms, report changes, complete interviews, and talk about your case with us?*

☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

Name of Person or Agency: _____

Phone Number: _____

Federal Employer Identification Number (Agency Only): _____

* Permission valid until cancelled.

Authorized Representative for EBT Transactions

Do you want to give someone you trust permission to get an EBT card to food shop for you using your SNAP benefits?*

☐ Yes ☐ No

If **yes**, please fill out the section below:

Name of Person or Agency: _____

Phone Number: _____

Address: _____

* Identity must be verified before a card is issued. Permission valid until cancelled.

- If you want to cancel an EBT card for an Authorized Representative, call 1-800-997-2555.
- If you want to cancel any of the above roles, call 1-877-382-2363.

What Happens Next?

Please keep the following pages for your records.



Phone Call

We will call you for an interview. If we cannot reach you, we will mail you a letter for a scheduled phone interview. You can also call us at 1-833-712-8027, Monday through Friday from 8:15-4:45, to do an interview.

Send in Verifications

If needed, we will give you a list of documents to send so we can verify your eligibility. You have 30 days from when you apply to send us the documents. Tell us if you need help!

Get SNAP Benefits

We will mail you a decision letter within 30 days. If approved, we will put benefits on your EBT card. If denied, we will tell you why.

Get Connected

Visit DTACconnect.com, use the DTA Connect mobile app, or call the DTA Assistance Line at 1-877-382-2363 to check case status, update case information, upload documents, and much more!

If you want more information or need help, call **1-833-712-8027** or visit Mass.gov/DTA.

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

SNAP Path to Work: Find Employment & Training providers by going to SNAPpathtowork.org.

Note: This is for SNAP-only clients

Massachusetts 2-1-1: Call 211 to find health and human services programs in your area.

SNAP-Ed: Visit the SNAP Nutrition Education website at MAhealthyfoodsinasnap.org to find healthy recipes, cooking tips, and ways to keep your family active!

Project Bread: Call Project Bread's Food Source Hotline at 1-800-645-8333 to find local food sources.

YOUR VERIFICATION OPTIONS

- You can use this checklist to submit verifications with this application. This will help us complete your application faster!
- If you do not have all the proofs, do NOT wait to submit your application! You can submit them later.
- For more information, visit Mass.gov/SNAPverifications.

- ☐ **If anyone in the household has earned income**, send us proof of gross income (before taxes) for the last four weeks, such as:
- ☐ Pay stubs, or record of payment
 - ☐ Proof of any pay you got and hours worked
 - ☐ If self-employed, business documents that show income and business expenses, such as:
 - ☐ Schedule C (1040 IRS form)
 - ☐ 1099 IRS form or other tax record
 - ☐ Other records such as invoices, bills, or receipts that show your income and/or business expenses

- ☐ **If anyone in the household has unearned income**, send us proof of the monthly amount, such as:
- ☐ Benefit or award letter
 - ☐ Statement from agency making payments

NOTE: We can usually verify the amount of Social Security, SSI, DOR Child Support, or MA Unemployment Compensation benefits ourselves. We will tell you if you need to verify any of these items.

- ☐ **To prove Massachusetts residency**, you may submit one of the following:
- ☐ Rent receipt, lease, or Landlord Verification form
 - ☐ Deed or mortgage statement, utility bill, or voter registration
 - ☐ Shared Housing Verification form, or statement from someone you live with

- ☐ **If anyone in the household is making payments for child support**, please send us:
- ☐ Proof of the legal obligation to pay the child support (such as a court order) and
 - ☐ Proof of recent payments

☐ **If any household member is a noncitizen applying for benefits**, please submit proof of noncitizen status, such as:

- ☐ Permanent Resident Card (“green card”)
- ☐ Employment Authorization Card
- ☐ Temporary Resident Card
- ☐ Arrival-Departure Record (I-94)
- ☐ Stamp in passport
- ☐ Other document showing current or pending immigration status
- ☐ Statement from an immigration attorney about current or pending status

☐ **If any household member is elderly and/or disabled and has medical expenses**, please submit proof of expenses (such as bills, invoices, or receipts). Some transportation costs for medical reasons can be self-declared.

NOTE: The total medical expenses for the household must be higher than \$35 per month to be counted.

☐ **If anyone in the household has shelter costs**, send us proof such as:

- ☐ Rent receipt
- ☐ Lease
- ☐ Letter from your landlord
- ☐ Cancelled check or money order
- ☐ Mortgage statement
- ☐ Property tax or home insurance bill
- ☐ If you are not the primary tenant or the homeowner, provide a statement from the person you live with stating what your share of the shelter and utility expenses are
- ☐ Other documents saying the cost and type of expense you must pay

☐ **If anyone in the household has utility costs**, send us proof such as:

- ☐ Bill for heat, air conditioning, electricity, gas, or phone
- ☐ Bill for other utility costs, such as coal, wood for heating, garbage collection, water and sewer
- ☐ Lease showing you pay for utilities
- ☐ Letter from landlord or roommate

☐ **If anyone in the household has dependent care costs**, send us proof such as:

- ☐ Statement or letter from provider
- ☐ Receipts, cancelled check, or money order

- ☐ All SNAP clients must follow the ABAWD Work Rules unless they meet an exemption.
 - ☐ For a list of exemptions and more information on the SNAP Work Rules, visit www.mass.gov/snapworkrules or call 877-382-2363

Department of Transitional Assistance (DTA) Notice of Rights, Responsibilities and Penalties

- This notice lists rights and responsibilities for all DTA programs. You must follow the rules for programs you apply for.
- Please read these pages and keep them for your records.
- Let DTA know if you have any questions.

I swear under penalty of perjury that:

- I have read the information in this form, or someone read it to me.
- My answers in this form are true and complete to the best of my knowledge.
- I will give DTA information that is true and complete to the best of my knowledge during my interview and in the future.

I understand that:

- giving false or misleading information is fraud,
- misrepresenting or withholding facts to get DTA benefits is fraud,
- fraud is considered an Intentional Program Violation (IPV), and
- if DTA thinks I committed fraud, DTA can pursue civil and criminal penalties against me.

I also understand that:

- DTA will verify the information I give with my application. If any information is false, DTA may deny my benefits.
- I may also be subject to criminal prosecution for providing false information.
- If DTA gets information from a reliable source about a change in my household, my benefit amount may change.
- By signing this form, I give DTA permission to verify my eligibility for benefits, including:
 - Get information from other state or federal agencies, local housing authorities, out-of-state welfare departments, financial institutions, and Equifax Workforce Solutions (the Work Number). I also give these agencies permission to share information about my household's eligibility for benefits with DTA.
 - If DTA uses information from Equifax about my household earned income, I have the right to a free copy of my Equifax report if I request it within 60 days of DTA's decision. I have the right to question the information in the report. I may contact Equifax at: Equifax Workforce Solutions, 11432 Lackland Road, St. Louis, MO 63146, 1-800-996-7566 (toll free).
- I have a right to a copy of my application, including the information that DTA uses to decide about my household's eligibility and benefit amount. I can ask DTA for an electronic copy of the completed application.

How will DTA use my information?

By signing below, I give DTA permission to get information from and share information about me and members of my household with:

- Banks, schools, government, employers, landlords, utility companies and other agencies to check if I am eligible for benefits.
- Electric, gas and telephone companies so I can get utility discounts. The companies cannot share my information or use it for any other purpose.

- The Department of Housing and Community Development to enroll me in the Heat & Eat Program. This program helps people get the most SNAP benefits possible.
- The Department of Early and Secondary Education so my children can get free school meals.
- The Woman, Infants and Children (WIC) Program so that any children under age 5 or a pregnant woman in my household can get WIC.
- The United States Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS), to verify my immigration status. Information from USCIS may affect my household's eligibility and amount of DTA benefits.

Note: Even if you are not eligible for benefits due to immigration status, DTA will not report you to immigration authorities unless you show DTA a final order of deportation.

- The Department of Revenue (DOR) to verify my eligibility for income-based tax credits, such as Earned Income and Limited Income, and to see if I am eligible for "No Tax Status" or hardship status.
- The Department of Children and Families (DCF) to coordinate services offered jointly by DTA and DCF.

How does DTA use Social Security Numbers (SSNs)?

DTA is allowed to ask for SSNs under The Food and Nutrition Act of 2008 (7 U.S.C. 2011-2036) for SNAP and under M.G.L. c. 18 Section 33 for TAFDC and EAEDC. DTA uses SSNs to:

- Check the identity and eligibility of each household member I apply for through data matching programs.
- Monitor compliance with program rules.
- Collect money if DTA claims I got benefits that I was not eligible for.
- Help law enforcement agencies catch people hiding from the law.

I understand that I do not have to give DTA the SSN of any non-citizen in my household, including myself, who does not want benefits. The income of a non-citizen may count even if the non-citizen does not get benefits.

Right to an Interpreter

I understand that:

- I have a right to a free professional interpreter provided by DTA if I prefer to communicate in a language other than English.
- If I have a DTA hearing, I can ask DTA to give me a free professional interpreter, or if I prefer, I can bring someone to interpret for me. If I need DTA to give me an interpreter for a hearing, I must call the Division of Hearings at least one week before the hearing date.

Right to Register to Vote

I understand that:

- I have the right to register to vote through DTA.
- DTA will help me fill out the voter registration application form if I want help.
- I can fill out the voter registration application form in private.
- Applying to register or declining to register to vote will not affect my DTA benefits.

Employment Opportunities

I agree that DTA may share my name and contact information with employment and training providers, including:

- SNAP Path Work providers or DTA specialists for SNAP clients; and
- Contracted Employment and Training providers or Full Engagement Workers for TAFDC clients.

SNAP clients may voluntarily participate in education and employment training services through the SNAP Path to Work program.

Citizenship Status

I swear that all members of my household applying for DTA benefits are either U.S. citizens, or lawfully residing noncitizens.

Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program

I understand that:

- DTA manages the SNAP program in Massachusetts.
- When I file an application with DTA (by phone, online, in person, or by mail or fax), DTA has 30 days from the date it got my application to decide if I am eligible.
 - If I am eligible for expedited (emergency) SNAP, DTA has to give me SNAP and make sure I have an Electronic Benefit Transfer (EBT) card within 7 days from the date they got my application.
 - I have a right to speak to a DTA supervisor if:
 - DTA says I am not eligible for emergency SNAP benefits, and I disagree.
 - I am eligible for emergency SNAP benefits, but do not get my benefits by the 7th day after I applied for SNAP.
 - I am eligible for emergency SNAP benefits but do not get my EBT card by the 7th day after I applied for SNAP.
- When I get SNAP, I have to meet certain rules. When I am approved for SNAP, DTA will give me a copy of the “Your Right to Know” brochure and the SNAP Program brochure. I will read the brochures or have someone read them to me. If I have any questions or need help reading or understanding this information, I can call DTA at 1-877-382-2363.

Telling DTA about changes in my household:

- If I am a SNAP Simplified Reporting household, I do not have to report most changes to DTA until the Interim Report or Recertification is due. The only things I have to report sooner are:
 - If my household's income goes over the gross income threshold (listed on my approval notice).
 - I have to report this by the 10th day of the month after the month my income went over the threshold.
 - If I have to meet the Able-Bodied Adults Without Dependents (ABAWD) Work Rules and my work hours drop below 20 hours per week.
- If everyone in my household is 60 or older, disabled, or under 18 years old, and no one has earnings from work, the only things I have to report are:
 - If someone starts working, or
 - Someone joins or leaves my household.
 - I have to report these changes by the 10th day of the month after the month of the change.
- If I get SNAP through Transitional Benefits Alternative (TBA) because my TAFDC stopped, I do not have to report any changes to DTA for the 5 months that I get TBA.
- If I get SNAP through Bay State CAP, I do not have to report any changes to DTA.

If I and everyone in my household gets cash assistance (TAFDC or EAEDC), I must report certain changes to DTA within 10 days of the change. See **When do I need to tell DTA about changes in my household? under Transitional Aid to Families with Dependent Children (TAFDC) and Emergency Aid to the Elderly, Disabled, and Children (EAEDC)** below.

- I may get more SNAP benefits if I report and give DTA proofs for the following, at any time:
- Child or other dependent care costs, shelter costs, and/or utility costs;
- Child support that I (or someone in my household) is legally required to pay to a non-household member; and
- Medical costs for members of my household, including myself, who are 60 or older or disabled.

Work rules for SNAP clients: If you get SNAP benefits and are between the ages of 16 and 59 you may need to meet general SNAP work rules or the ABAWD work rules unless you are exempt. DTA will tell me and members of my household if we need to meet any Work Rules, what the exemptions are, and what will happen if we do not meet the rules.

If you are under the SNAP Work Rules:

- You must register for work at application and when you recertify for SNAP. You register when you sign the SNAP application or recertification form.
- You must give DTA information about your employment status when DTA asks.
- You must report to an employer if referred by DTA.
- You must accept a job offer (unless you have a good reason not to).
- You must not quit a job of more than 30 hours a week without a good reason.
- You must not cut your work hours to less than 30 hours a week without a good reason.

SNAP Rules

- Do not give false information or hide information to get SNAP benefits.
- Do not trade or sell SNAP benefits.
- Do not alter EBT cards to get SNAP benefits you are not eligible for.
- Do not use SNAP benefits to buy ineligible items, such as alcoholic drinks and tobacco.
- Do not use someone else's SNAP benefits or EBT card unless you are an authorized representative, or the recipient has given you permission to use their card on their behalf.

SNAP Penalty Warnings

I understand that if I or any member of my SNAP household intentionally breaks any of the rules listed above, that person will not be eligible for SNAP for one year after the first violation, two years after the second violation and forever after the third violation. That person may also be fined up to \$250,000, imprisoned up to 20 years, or both. They may also be subject to prosecution under Federal and State laws.

I also understand the following penalties. If I or a member of my SNAP household:

- Commit a **cash program** Intentional Program Violation (IPV) they will be ineligible for SNAP for the same period they are ineligible for cash assistance.
- Make a fraudulent statement about their identity or residency to get multiple SNAP benefits at the same time they will be ineligible for SNAP for **ten years**.
- Trade (buy or sell) SNAP benefits for a controlled substance/illegal drug(s), they will be ineligible for SNAP for **two years** for the first finding, and **forever** for the second finding.
- Trade (buy or sell) SNAP benefits for firearms, ammunition or explosives, they will be ineligible for SNAP forever.
- Make an offer to sell SNAP benefits or an EBT card online or in person the State may pursue an IPV against them.
- Pay for food purchased on credit they will be ineligible for SNAP.
- Buy products with SNAP benefits with the intent to discard the contents and return containers for cash they will be ineligible for SNAP.
- Flee to avoid prosecution, custody or confinement after conviction for a felony they will be ineligible for SNAP.
- Violate probation or parole, where law enforcement is actively seeking to arrest them they will be ineligible for SNAP.

Anyone who became a convicted felon after February 7, 2014 is ineligible for SNAP benefits if they are a fleeing felon or are violating probation or parole - in accordance with 7 CFR §273.11(n) - **and** were convicted as an adult of:

1. Aggravated sexual abuse under section 2241 of title 18, U.S.C.;
2. Murder under section 1111 of title 18, U.S.C.;
3. Any offense under chapter 110 of title 18, U.S.C.;
4. A Federal or State offense involving sexual assault, as defined in section 40002(a) of the 1994 VAWA (42 U.S.C. 13925a); or
5. An offense under State law determined by the Attorney General to be substantially similar to an offense described in this list.

Nondiscrimination Statement

In accordance with Federal civil rights law and U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) regulations and policies, the USDA, its Agencies, offices, and employees, and institutions participating in or administering USDA programs are prohibited from discriminating based on race, color, national origin, sex, religious creed, disability, age, political beliefs, or reprisal or retaliation for prior civil rights activity in any program or activity conducted or funded by USDA. Persons with disabilities who require alternative means of communication for program information (e.g. Braille, large print, audiotope, American Sign Language, etc.), should contact the Agency (state or local) where they applied for benefits. Individuals who are deaf, hard of hearing or have speech disabilities may contact USDA through the Federal Relay Service at 1-800-877-8339. Additionally, program information may be made available in languages other than English.

To file a program complaint of discrimination:

- Complete the USDA Program Discrimination Complaint Form, (AD-3027) found online at: <https://www.usda.gov/sites/default/files/documents/usda-program-discrimination-complaint-form.pdf>, and at any USDA office. You can ask for a copy of the complaint form by calling 1-866-632-9992; or
- Write a letter addressed to USDA and put in the letter all of the information requested in the form.

Submit your completed form or letter to USDA by:

- mail: U.S. Department of Agriculture Office of the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights 1400 Independence Avenue SW Washington, D.C. 20250-9410; or
- fax: 1-202-690-7442; or
- email: program.intake@usda.gov

This institution is an equal opportunity provider.

Transitional Aid to Families with Dependent Children (TAFDC) and

Transitional Aid to Families with Dependent Children (TAFDC) and Emergency Aid to the Elderly, Disabled, and Children (EAEDC)

TAFDC and EAEDC are cash assistance programs. To learn more and to apply, visit DTAConnect.com or call your local DTA office. This information only applies to households who are applying for or get TAFDC or EAEDC.

When do I need to tell DTA about changes in my household?

I must tell DTA about changes that could affect my TAFDC or EAEDC (cash benefits) within 10 days, except that I do not have to tell DTA about a change in my earnings of less than \$100 per month. This includes changes in my income, address, who I live with, family size, work, and health insurance.

How do I get health insurance?

- If I get TAFDC or EAEDC, I will get MassHealth too.
- If I am denied TAFDC or EAEDC, MassHealth will use my information to see if I am eligible for health insurance.
- If my EAEDC stops, I need to apply for MassHealth separately. To ask for an application call 1-800-841-2900.

If I get MassHealth, I agree that MassHealth may collect:

- money owed to me from another source for my medical care, and
- medical support from the absent parent of any child under age 19 who gets MassHealth benefits.

Are there special rules if I am eligible only because of an accident or injury?

If my family gets benefits from MassHealth or DTA because of an accident or injury, I must use any money I get for the accident or injury to pay them back. The money could be from an insurance policy, a settlement, or any other source. This applies even if I do not know what the possible sources of money are yet.

I agree to cooperate with MassHealth and DTA by:

- Filing claims for money from other sources.
- Telling MassHealth and DTA right away about any insurance claim, lawsuit, or other process to get money.
- Giving MassHealth and DTA new information when I get it.

If I don't cooperate, MassHealth and DTA may stop or deny my benefits. I agree that MassHealth and DTA may:

- Share information about my benefits in order to collect money to repay those benefits.
- See all records about money I might get due to the accident or injury, such as records at the Department of Industrial Accidents.

If I am getting EAEDC because I have a disability or I am over 65 years old, I have to apply for federal Supplemental Security Income (SSI) benefits. If I am approved for SSI benefits that cover the same time that I got EAEDC, the Social Security Administration will send some of my retroactive SSI to DTA to repay the EAEDC.

Important Notice About the Law and Your Benefits

An Intentional Program Violation (IPV) is intentionally giving a false or misleading statement or misrepresenting, hiding, or withholding facts, either orally or in writing, in order to establish or maintain eligibility for TAFDC or EAEDC benefits, or to gain benefits to which I am not entitled. If I am found guilty of an IPV by a court of law, an administrative disqualification hearing, or by signing a waiver, I will be disqualified from receiving TAFDC or EAEDC benefits for a period of:

- 6 months for the first violation
- 12 months for the second violation
- forever for the third violation

In addition, other laws may apply.

Prohibitions on EBT Card Purchases

I understand it is illegal to use TAFDC or EAEDC funds held on an electronic benefit transfer (EBT) card to pay for the following: alcoholic beverages; tobacco products; lottery tickets; adult oriented material or performances; gambling; firearms and ammunition; vacation services; tattoos; body piercings; jewelry; televisions; stereos; video games or consoles at rent-to-own stores; recreational marijuana; court-ordered fees; fines; bail or bail bonds.

Prohibitions on Where I may Use My EBT Card

I understand it is illegal to use my electronic benefit transfer (EBT) card at the following locations: adult bookstores; adult paraphernalia stores or adult oriented performance establishments; ammunitions dealers; casinos; gambling casinos or gaming establishments; cruise ships; firearms dealers; jewelry stores; liquor stores; manicure shops or aesthetic shops; cash transmittal agencies to foreign countries; recreational marijuana stores or tattoo parlors.

Penalties for prohibited EBT card cash purchases

- First Offense: I must pay back DTA the amount spent.
- Second Offense: I must pay back DTA the amount spent and will lose cash benefits for two months.
- Third Offense: must pay back DTA the amount spent and will lose cash benefits permanently.

SIGNATURE:

By signing the application, I certify that I understand and agree to the “Rights, Responsibilities and Penalties.”

Applicant Signature: _____

Date: _____